

Baptiste Thornbury

Character Dossier

Competitive about everything ship's engineer of the harbor town of Saltmarsh

Overview

Baptiste Thornbury is a ship's engineer living in the harbor town of Saltmarsh. Baptiste is 58 years old, originally from the Mirefold, and is known around the Old Quay as competitive about everything. In conversation Baptiste gives directions by landmark, never by street name.

Background

Baptiste arrived in the harbor town of Saltmarsh 19 years ago after leaving the Mirefold under circumstances Baptiste describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Harbormasters' Guild; the second was the one that stuck. Today Baptiste works as a ship's engineer near Gull Street market and is paid, when paid at all, in silver marks.

Baptiste learned the trade from Kwame Norwood, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Baptiste's life is with Orsolya Quenneville, over a matter neither will explain. The person Baptiste trusts most is Kwame Norwood.

Current goal: to finish the great ledger of the harbor town of Saltmarsh. Greatest fear: the far side of the Old Quay.

Personality and speech

Temperament: competitive about everything.

Speech pattern: Baptiste gives directions by landmark, never by street name.

Tells: when lying, Baptiste mentions Turnip the hedgehog for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

Full name	Baptiste Thornbury
Role	ship's engineer
Home	the harbor town of Saltmarsh
Hometown	the Mirefold
Age	58
Favourite dish	the tavern's fried plantains
Pet	Turnip, a hedgehog

<i>Lucky number</i>	949
<i>Workshop password</i>	raven-fern
<i>Mentor</i>	Kwame Norwood
<i>Rival</i>	Orsolya Quenneville
<i>Closest friend</i>	Kwame Norwood

Secret

Baptiste sold a family heirloom to pay for Kwame Norwood's medicine and told everyone it was stolen.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Baptiste: I am the ship's engineer. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Baptiste: The tavern's fried plantains. Do not tell Orsolya I said so.

Visitor: Is Turnip yours?

Baptiste: Turnip belongs to nobody. Turnip tolerates me. Lucky number is 949, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, winter of year 36

Baptiste spent the day counting stock at the Old Quay: 47 of everything, except the cracked compass, which is always short. Baptiste spent the day counting stock at the Old Quay: 8 of everything, except the clockwork bird, which is always short. Baptiste was hired to carry a sextant from the Old Quay to the Brine and Bell tavern without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Juniper came by asking about the harvest count. Baptiste said nothing useful and made tea instead. Baptiste was hired to carry a grain scale from the Old Quay to the Brine and Bell tavern without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 2, autumn of year 36

Baptiste found a oilskin map half-buried near the Tidewatch lighthouse and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Baptiste repaired the grain scale at the Tidewatch lighthouse for Olwen, who paid in 26 silver marks and a long story about the right way to mend a net. Baptiste repaired the wax seal at the Tidewatch lighthouse for Lucienne, who paid in 18 silver marks and a long story about the new curfew. A stranger asked Baptiste for the password to the workshop. Baptiste laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Baptiste spent the day counting stock at the Tidewatch lighthouse: 14 of everything, except the oilskin map, which is always short.

Entry 3, autumn of year 36

At Gull Street market, Baptiste taught a newcomer how to tell a real tin whistle from a fake one by weight alone. Baptiste repaired the glass float at Gull Street market for Juniper, who paid in 73 silver marks and a long story about the singing at the docks. Rumours about the new curfew reached Gull Street market. Baptiste pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.